intro

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outline

data

introductions and discussion

- first syllabus so have basic idea about the class
- then lengthy introductions and research brainstorming
- more conversation than lecture: do interrupt, Q&A
- today very quick intro and quick overview of data, so you can get research going from day 1

sir, what is it?

- super-interdisciplinary:
  - psychology, sociology, geography, etc
- it's all quant (qual are just rich quant data)
- indicators:
  - subjective wellbeing (SWB), happiness, life satisfaction
  - objective quality of life (QOL)
  - freedom/agency/autonomy
  - culture, values: eg pref for redistribution
    (eg WVS data: are poor lazy? more govt resp v ppl?)
  - and many more

how do we study it?

- just download data
- usually surveys such as WVS
- a typical survey question:
- “are you satisfied with your life as a whole”
- on a Likert scale say from 1 to 5 or 1 to 10
- then regress it on what you’re interested in, say:
- age, edu, inc, ine, pov, etc

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data revolution, a ton of data!

- qualitative data (pictures, text, etc.) are just rich quantitative data and can be analyzed like quantitative!
- everything can be quantified or not? any examples of non-quantifiable things?

quick data sources (we will be adding more!)

- http://www.icpsr.umich.edu/icpsrweb/ICPSR/
  - https://www.icpsr.umich.edu/sites/icpsr/find-data/ssvd
- http://www.worldvaluessurvey.org/
- https://gssdataexplorer.norc.org/
- http://www.thearda.com/
- twitter county emotions https://dataverse.harvard.edu/dataset.xhtml?persistentId=doi:10.7910/DVN/T39JBY, my paper https://theaok.github.io/junk/hfgi.pdf and code: https://colab.research.google.com/github/theaok/hfgi/blob/main/hfgi.ipynb

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publish, not perish

- what to study? much time on this, already today >30min
  - passionate (and knowledgable) about
  - quality/quantity data easily available
  - career advancement [data from current/future workplace]
  - sth you've experienced! sth you want to figure out
  - e.g., inequality, i have millionaire cousins and broke ones
  - start figuring out topics and collaborations asap
- check out my research: `theaok.github.io`
- 2 questions about you:
  - what do you study?

    (can study just about anything with SIR)
  - what data are you using?